

Discover the Art of Prompting

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Today's Skill Points

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🔥 6 XP

Module 1

Large language models and their output

✓ Course 3 introduction: Discover the art of prompting  
Video • 3 min

✓ Understand large language models  
Video • 5 min

✓ Yufeng: Experiment with prompting  
Video • 3 min

Module 2

Key principles of effective prompt writing

✓ Write clear and specific prompts  
Video • 4 min

● Prompting best practices  
Reading • 12 min

● Activity: Write an effective prompt for Gemini  
Practice Assignment • 15 min

● Leverage an LLM's capabilities at work  
Video • 5 min

● Prompts for different purposes  
Reading • 8 min

● Coach dialogue: Transform a prompt  
Dialogue • 15 min

● Improve AI output through iteration  
Video • 5 min

● Activity: Iterate on prompts to find solutions  
Practice Assignment • 15 min

Module 3

Techniques for prompting an LLM

Module 4

Review: Discover the art of prompting

# Prompting best practices

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Prompting is an essential skill for getting the most out of generative AI. To get the best results from an AI tool, you need to craft a good prompt. A good prompt follows a simple framework: **Task, Context, References, Evaluate, and Iterate**. Explore how you can use this framework to elevate your prompting and unlock more of AI's benefits.



## Specify the task

The first step toward creating a great prompt is to clearly state the task, which is what you want an AI tool to do. Do you want it to draft an email or create an image? Be detailed, and avoid ambiguity, which might result in output that's incorrect or irrelevant.

When you provide an AI tool with a task, also consider including information about:

- **Persona:** What expertise do you want the AI tool to draw from, and who is the audience? For example, you might ask the tool to complete the task with the expertise of an IT professional, or ask it to create an output geared towards a specific audience like your manager or team.
- **Format:** How do you want the output to be formatted? For example, you might ask the AI tool to create a bulleted list or a comparison table.

Those additional pieces of information can help the AI tool accomplish the task the way you want it done.

Here's an example of a prompt that includes a specific **task**, a **persona**, and a **format**:

**Task:** Create a social media post about an upcoming music festival that speaks to the local music community while attracting out-of-state festival-goers.

**Persona:** You're a concert promoter specializing in raising ticket sales in the alternative rock music industry.

**Format:** Limit the post to 125-characters. Include 5 relevant hashtags.

## Provide necessary context

Including detailed context in your prompts can narrow an AI tool's focus and tailor its output. Contextual information in your prompts might include:

- Reasons and objectives for performing the task
- Rules or guidelines that the output must follow
- Relevant background information the tool should consider

Those details can help an AI tool better understand your needs. Here's an example of a prompt that provides necessary **context**:

You're a concert promoter specializing in raising ticket sales in the alternative rock music industry. Create a social media post about an upcoming music festival that speaks to the local music community while attracting out-of-state festival-goers. Limit the post to 125-characters. Include 5 relevant hashtags. **The local audience is primarily college students and young professionals (age 21-35) who follow indie rock. The festival features 12 bands over 2 days, with camping options and local food vendors.**

That prompt is more likely to generate a more engaging and effective output that's tailored to a specific audience—without requiring additional time spent iterating on the initial prompt.

## Include references as examples

References are examples or resources that illustrate what you want an AI tool to produce. They specify details about your desired output, such as the style, tone, and format. Depending on the AI tool, you can include text,